

033. Chapter 3 Verses 22-26

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.22

न मे पार्थास्ति कर्तव्यं त्रिषु लोकेषु किञ्चन ।
नानवाप्तमवाप्तव्यं वर्त एव च कर्मणि ॥ 22 ॥

na me pārthāsti kartavyaṃ
triṣu lokeṣu kiñcana |
nānavāptamavāptavyaṃ
varta eva ca karmaṇi ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **me** – for Me; **pārtha** – O Partha; **asti** – is; **kartavyam** – duty;
- ◆ **triṣu** – in the three; **lokeṣu** – worlds; **kiñcana** – any;
- ◆ **na** – not; **anavāptam** – unattained; **avāptavyam** – to be attained;
- ◆ **varte** – I am engaged; **eva** – also; **ca** – and; **karmaṇi** – in action.

There is no duty for me to do in the three worlds. There is nothing unattained or to be attained for me. And yet I am also engaged in work.

VERSE 3.23

यदि ह्यहं न वर्तेयं जातु कर्मण्यतन्द्रितः ।
मम वर्त्मानुवर्तन्ते मनुष्याः पार्थ सर्वशः ॥ 23 ॥

yadi hyaham na varteyam
jātu karmaṇyatandritaḥ |
mama vartmānuvarta nte
manuṣyāḥ pārtha sarvaśaḥ ||

- ◆ **yadi** – if; **hi** – indeed; **aham** – I; **na** – not; **varteyam** – should engage;
- ◆ **jātu** – ever; **karmaṇi** – in action; **atandritaḥ** – tirelessly;
- ◆ **mama** – My; **vartma** – path; **anuvartante** – follow;
- ◆ **manuṣyāḥ** – men; **pārtha** – O Partha; **sarvaśaḥ** – in every way.

**If I am not engaged in action always, without relaxation,
men follow my path in every way, O Arjuna!**

VERSE 3.24

उत्सीदेयुरिमे लोका न कुर्यां कर्म चेदहम् ।
सङ्करस्य च कर्ता स्यामुपहन्यामिमाः प्रजाः ॥ 24 ॥

utsīdeyurime lokā
na kuryām karma cedaham |
saṅkarasya ca kartā syām
upahanyāmimāḥ prajāḥ ||

- ◆ **utsīdeyuh** – would perish; **ime** – these; **lokāḥ** – worlds;
- ◆ **na kuryām** – did not perform; **karma** – action; **cet** – if; **aham** – I;
- ◆ **saṅkarasya** – of confusion/admixture; **ca** – and; **kartā** – author; **syām** – I would be;
- ◆ **upahanyām** – would destroy; **imāḥ** – these; **prajāḥ** – beings.

These worlds would perish if I do not perform work; I would be the cause of the confusion of species and the destruction of these beings.

VERSE 3.25

सक्ताः कर्मण्यविद्वांसो यथा कुर्वन्ति भारत ।
कुर्याद्विद्वांस्तथासक्तश्चिकीर्षुर्लोकसंग्रहम् ॥ 25 ॥

saktāḥ karmaṇyavidvāṃso
yathā kurvanti bhārata |
kuryādvidvāṃstathāsakta
ścikīrṣurlokasaṅgraham ||

- ◆ **saktāḥ** – attached; **karmaṇi** – to action; **avidvāṃsaḥ** – the ignorant;
- ◆ **yathā** – as; **kurvanti** – perform; **bhārata** – O Bharata;
- ◆ **kuryāt** – should perform; **vidvān** – the wise; **tathā** – so; **asaktaḥ** – unattached;
- ◆ **cikīrṣuḥ** – wishing; **loka-saṅgraham** – welfare of the world.

O Arjuna! As the ignorant men work with attachment to action, so should the wise act without attachment, for the welfare of the world.

VERSE 3.26

न बुद्धिभेदं जनयेदज्ञानां कर्मसङ्गिनाम् ।
जोषयेत्सर्वकर्माणि विद्वान्युक्तः समाचरन् ॥ 26 ॥

na buddhibhedam janayed
ajñānām karmasaṅginām |
joṣayetsarvakarmāṇi
vidvānyuktaḥ samācaran ||

- ◆ **na** – not; **buddhi-bhedam** – confusion of intellect; **janayet** – should create;
- ◆ **ajñānām** – of the ignorant; **karma-saṅginām** – attached to action;
- ◆ **joṣayet** – should encourage/inspire; **sarva-karmāṇi** – all actions;
- ◆ **vidvān** – the wise; **yuktaḥ** – disciplined/steadfast; **samācaran** – performing well.

The wise man should not disturb and confuse the minds of the ignorant attached to action. By performing all actions with yogic equanimity, they should make the ignorant do accordingly.